CASCADIA ANALYTICS

Amprius Technologies, Inc.

Equity Research Note | AMPX | 21 OCTOBER 2026

Inflection Is Real

Amprius Technologies screens as a Hold, Valuation Concerns with a $5.73 blended target, 24% below the current price.

Analyst: Justin Wen

REFERENCE PRICE	BLENDED TARGET	BLENDED UPSIDE	
$7.58	$5.73	-24%	HOLD, VALUATION CONCERNS

Investment Thesis

Inflection Is Real. Revenue of $34M in Q2 [8-K guid], up 126% YoY, with the FY26 guide raised to at least $140M [8-K guid] for the second straight quarter. Net margin improved to -9.3% [10-Q Q2 2026] from -42% a year ago. Orders Back the Story. $24M European drone order, multi-year Stark Future deal over $100M, Redwire Stalker Block 30 supply, and a $75M DoW grant to build US drone-cell capacity [8-K]. Demand is confirmed, not hoped. Price Ahead of Fundamentals. At $7.58 [Mkt 17-Oct-26], the DCF base of $5.20

- Inflection Is Real
- Orders Back the Story
- Price Ahead of Fundamentals

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The latest print

Orders Back the Story. $24M European drone order, multi-year Stark Future deal over $100M, Redwire Stalker Block 30 supply, and a $75M DoW grant to build US drone-cell capacity. Demand is confirmed, not hoped.

Price Ahead of Fundamentals. At $7.58, the DCF base of $5.20 implies 31% downside, and 14.7x TTM revenue is a steep price for a still-loss-making company. Growth deserves a premium; the current premium prices in the bull case.

$34.0M	27%	$140M+	-9.3%	$74.5M	$4M+
REVENUE (Q2 2026)	GROSS MARGIN (Q2 2026)	FY2026 REVENUE GUIDE	NET MARGIN (Q2 2026)	CASH (Q2 2026)	ADJUSTED EBITDA GUIDE (FY26)

Key metrics in detail

METRIC	LATEST	VS YEAR AGO	TREND
Revenue (Q2 2026)	$34.0M	+126%	Up
Gross Margin (Q2 2026)	27%	n/a	Up
FY2026 Revenue Guide	$140M+	+95% vs 2025	Up
Net Margin (Q2 2026)	-9.3%	+33 pts	Up
Cash (Q2 2026)	$74.5M	+37%	Up
Adjusted EBITDA Guide (FY26)	$4M+	n/a	Up
DoW Grant (Project acCELLerate)	up to $75M	new	Up

The moat

Silicon-anode cells with up to 2x energy density of graphite, validated by defense and drone OEM demand

The growth engine

NDAA-compliant US supply chain via DoW IBAS grant and contract manufacturing partnerships

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Three scenarios make the valuation range explicit

Three scenarios, weighted 25% / 50% / 25% into the blended target.

SCENARIO	WEIGHT	2026-30 CAGR	2030 REVENUE	2030 EBIT MARGIN	TARGET	UPSIDE
Bear	25%	18.0%	$271M	14.5%	**$2.18**	-71%
Base	50%	38.5%	$515M	19.7%	**$5.20**	-31%
Bull	25%	55.0%	$808M	25.0%	**$10.36**	+37%

Bear: downside case at $2.18 (-71%).

Base: central case at $5.20 (-31%).

Bull: upside case at $10.36 (+37%).

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The probability-blended target implies 24% downside

A 25% Bear / 50% Base / 25% Bull weighting implies -24% from the $7.58 reference price.

$5.73
BLENDED TARGET

The valuation uses a multi-year unlevered free cash flow DCF. The discount rate is the live CAPM rate: the 10-year Treasury yield plus beta times the market-implied equity risk premium. Terminal value is a Gordon perpetuity on terminal-year free cash flow.

Mechanics are explicit. The bridge runs revenue to EBIT to cash taxes, then adds back D&A and subtracts capex and working-capital investment to reach unlevered free cash flow. Targets are divided by diluted shares outstanding.

Revenue base (2025E)	**$140M**
Valuation horizon	**2026-2030**
Live WACC	**11.27%**
Terminal growth	**3.5%**
Net cash	**$74.5M**
2030 FCF (Base)	**$73.6M**
10-year Treasury yield	**5.1%**
Beta	**1.80**
Equity risk premium	**3.4%**

HOLD, VALUATION CONCERNS | $5.73 BLENDED TARGET | WEN

The reverse DCF: what the market prices in

Holding the base-case FCF margin flat, the market-implied revenue CAGR is 48.4%. at/above Base (38.5%) — constructive

Reverse DCF sensitivity

Implied enterprise value and share price at each five-year revenue CAGR, with the base-case free cash flow margin held flat. The highlighted row sits nearest the market-implied CAGR.

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CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price	CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price	CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price
+0%	$0.2B	$2.16	+20%	$0.5B	$3.70	+40%	$0.8B	$6.18
+1%	$0.2B	$2.22	+21%	$0.5B	$3.80	+41%	$0.8B	$6.34
+2%	$0.3B	$2.28	+22%	$0.5B	$3.90	+42%	$0.9B	$6.50
+3%	$0.3B	$2.34	+23%	$0.5B	$4.01	+43%	$0.9B	$6.66
+4%	$0.3B	$2.41	+24%	$0.5B	$4.11	+44%	$0.9B	$6.82
+5%	$0.3B	$2.47	+25%	$0.5B	$4.22	+45%	$0.9B	$6.99
+6%	$0.3B	$2.54	+26%	$0.5B	$4.33	+46%	$1.0B	$7.16
+7%	$0.3B	$2.61	+27%	$0.6B	$4.45	+47%	$1.0B	$7.33
+8%	$0.3B	$2.68	+28%	$0.6B	$4.56	**+48%**	**$1.0B**	**$7.51**
+9%	$0.3B	$2.75	+29%	$0.6B	$4.68	+49%	$1.0B	$7.69
+10%	$0.3B	$2.83	+30%	$0.6B	$4.81	+50%	$1.1B	$7.88
+11%	$0.3B	$2.91	+31%	$0.6B	$4.93	+51%	$1.1B	$8.07
+12%	$0.4B	$2.99	+32%	$0.7B	$5.06	+52%	$1.1B	$8.26
+13%	$0.4B	$3.07	+33%	$0.7B	$5.19	+53%	$1.1B	$8.46
+14%	$0.4B	$3.15	+34%	$0.7B	$5.32	+54%	$1.2B	$8.66
+15%	$0.4B	$3.24	+35%	$0.7B	$5.46	+55%	$1.2B	$8.86
+16%	$0.4B	$3.33	+36%	$0.7B	$5.60	+56%	$1.2B	$9.07
+17%	$0.4B	$3.42	+37%	$0.7B	$5.74	+57%	$1.3B	$9.28
+18%	$0.4B	$3.51	+38%	$0.8B	$5.88	+58%	$1.3B	$9.49
+19%	$0.4B	$3.60	+39%	$0.8B	$6.03			

Balance sheet and share count reconciliation

Enterprise value converts to equity value after net debt, and targets divide by diluted shares.

SCENARIO	ENTERPRISE VALUE	EXIT EV/ FCF	TERMINAL GROWTH	PLUS: NET CASH	EQUITY VALUE	TARGET
Bear	$238M	—	3.5%	$74.5M	$312M	**$2.18**
Base	$672M	—	3.5%	$74.5M	$746M	**$5.20**
Bull	$1.41B	—	3.5%	$74.5M	$1.49B	**$10.36**

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Fair value across scenarios

Model fair value by year under each scenario, on the same paths the ticker page chart draws.

SCENARIO	2026	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Bear	$2.41	$2.41	$2.67	$2.92	$3.16	$3.39
Base	$5.76	$5.76	$6.39	$7.04	$7.66	$8.21
Bull	$11.50	$11.50	$12.77	$14.11	$15.42	$16.55

Methodology note. The discount rate is the live U.S. 10-year Treasury yield plus beta times equity risk premium. Terminal growth reflects long-run nominal GDP. The $5.73 headline target applies 25% / 50% / 25% Bear / Base / Bull weights.

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The franchise deep dive

Silicon-anode cells with up to 2x energy density of graphite, validated by defense and drone OEM demand

NDAA-compliant US supply chain via DoW IBAS grant and contract manufacturing partnerships

$600M revenue long-term target with 30%+ gross margin and 20% adjusted EBITDA margin by 2030

Revenue and margin trend

METRIC	2022	2023	2024	2025	TTM
Revenue	$4.2M	$8.8M	$23.6M	$71.9M	$109.2M
Gross Margin	n/a	n/a	n/a	27% (Q2'26)	22.3%
Op Margin	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	-12.6%

Valuation cross-check

EV/Revenue (TTM) 14.7x

DCF Base $5.20

P/E (fwd) 77x

DCF implies 31% downside. A 77x forward P/E and 14.7x revenue for a pre-profit company prices in near-perfect execution.

Battery-material peers trade at high revenue multiples pre-scale

AMPX is not an outlier vs speculative battery peers, but the peer group itself is expensive; defense-contracted revenue earns only a partial premium.

52-week range $6.68 - $24.23

Trading 68% below its highs, but multiples are still rich relative to the company's own trading history given it remains loss-making.

What to monitor

Nov 2026. Q3 2026 Earnings (Two-Sided): Must show H2 delivery against the $140M guide; a beat would validate the EBITDA breakeven story.

Q4 2026. SiCore 500 Commercial Availability (Positive): 500 Wh/kg cell on conventional lines; de-risks the industrialization question.

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2026-2027. DoW Grant Milestones (Two-Sided): Up to $75M OTA, but majority is unfunded and tied to appropriations; accepted deliverables unlock payments.

Financial summary: income statement

YEAR	REVENUE	GROSS PROFIT	OPERATING INCOME	EBITDA
2022	$4M	$-6M	$-18M	$-17M
2023	$9M	$-15M	$-39M	$-37M
2024	$24M	$-18M	$-44M	$-40M
2025	$72M	$8M	$-23M	$-19M

Balance sheet

YEAR	TOTAL ASSETS	TOTAL LIABILITIES	TOTAL EQUITY	CASH
2022	$83M	$10M	$73M	$70M
2023	$108M	$48M	$60M	$46M
2024	$121M	$52M	$69M	$55M
2025	$157M	$53M	$104M	$90M

Cash flow

YEAR	OPERATING CF	CAPEX	FINANCING CF	FREE CF
2022	$-14M	$-1M	$74M	$-15M
2023	$-26M	$-18M	$19M	$-43M
2024	$-33M	$-3M	$47M	$-37M
2025	$-31M	$-4M	$71M	$-36M

Methodology note. The discount rate is the live U.S. 10-year Treasury yield plus beta times equity risk premium. Terminal growth reflects long-run nominal GDP. The $5.73 headline target applies 25% / 50% / 25% Bear / Base / Bull weights.

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Agency risk score 20 of 100: high agency risk, the value-trap profile

The score follows the website's Executive Alignment & Agency Risk model: insider ownership up to 40 points, open-market Form 4 flow over the trailing six months up to 30, and pay-for-performance up to 30. Insiders hold 1.18% of shares outstanding. Form 4 filings over the trailing six months show $0 of open-market purchases against $6.32M of sales, a net flow of -$6.32M. One-year total shareholder return is -33.5% against CEO total pay of $768.6K (Mr. Thomas Michael Stepien), which the model scores as SUB-OPTIMAL ALIGNMENT.

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AGENCY RISK SCORE, OF 100

The three components

COMPONENT	SCORE	WHAT THE SITE SHOWS
Insider Ownership (Skin in the Game)	8 / 40	1.18% of shares held by insiders
Form 4 Flow (Conviction Flow)	0 / 30	Buys $0 (0) vs sales $6.32M (13), net -$6.32M, trailing six months
Pay-for-Performance	12 / 30	SUB-OPTIMAL ALIGNMENT: Negative Shareholder Returns vs Static Executive Comp. 1Y TSR -33.5%; Mr. Thomas Michael Stepien, CEO, President & Director, total pay $768.6K
Agency Risk Score	**20 / 100**	Regime: HIGH AGENCY RISK // VALUE TRAP

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Recent Form 4 filings

DATE	FILER	RELATION	TYPE	SHARES	VALUE
2026-08-24	Stepien Thomas M	Chief Executive Officer	SELL	31,529	$323.6K
2026-08-21	Sun Kang	Director	SELL	62,101	$642.2K
2026-08-21	Stefan Constantin Ionel	Chief Technology Officer	SELL	29,681	$306.9K
2026-06-15	Dixon Donald R.	Director	SELL	85,000	$1.46M
2026-06-09	Dixon Donald R.	Director	SELL	40,000	$765.2K
2026-06-04	Stepien Thomas M	Chief Executive Officer	SELL	2,000	$41.9K
2026-05-27	Sun Kang	Director	SELL	356	$6.1K
2026-05-27	Stefan Constantin Ionel	Chief Technology Officer	SELL	3,208	$55.2K

SEC proxy audit, DEF 14A filed 2026-04-29

Alignment grade F. NO PAY CHANGE. Thomas M. Stepien, fiscal 2025 vs fiscal 2024; total compensation change year on year: N/A.

BASE SALARY	STOCK AWARDS	NON-EQUITY INCENTIVE	OTHER COMPENSATION
N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

Insufficient data to assess compensation shift; no evidence of bonus impact or committee accountability.

Proxy audit source: SEC EDGAR DEF 14A, audited 2026-10-18 by the weekly proxy pipeline. Filing: https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1899287/000189928726000026/ampx-20260428.htm

Methodology. This module reuses the website's Executive Alignment & Agency Risk model unchanged. Scores of 75 and above band as founder-mode, high conviction; 45 to 74 as balanced, typical corporate; below 45 as high agency risk. Inputs are the same feeds behind the site model (Yahoo Finance insider holdings, Form 4 transactions and executive compensation) plus the SEC DEF 14A CD&A audit from the weekly proxy pipeline. Computed 21 October 2026 for this note.

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The bear case

Grant Funding Risk

A majority of the $75M award is unfunded and depends on future appropriations, with payments tied to government-accepted milestones. Delivery delays or funding gaps would stall the 12M-cells-per-year plan.

Cash Runway

$74.5M in cash against a recent quarterly burn pace that has been lumpy. If the promised EBITDA breakeven slips, dilution is the likely backstop.

Volatility and Shorts

Beta of 2.35, short interest near 17-19% of float, and the stock trading 68% below its 52-week high. Any execution miss gets punished hard.

The strengths

Operating Quality

Pre-profit with no moat from earnings, but the technology is genuinely validated: 500 Wh/kg SiCore cells, NDAA-compliant supply, DoW funding, and paying customers. Gross margin hit 27% and the capital-light contract manufacturing model keep

Recent Trend

Revenue +153% (Q1) then +126% (Q2), guidance raised twice in a row, net margin improved from -42% to -9% in a year, and EBITDA breakeven is imminent. One of the cleanest inflection trajectories in coverage.

Forward Growth

$24M European drone order, $100M+ multi-year Stark Future deal, Redwire Stalker Block 30 supply wins, and a $75M DoW OTA (mostly unfunded, tied to appropriations). The $140M FY26 guide is confirmed by orders, but 2027+ capacity depends on c

Valuation

DCF base $5.20 implies 31% downside at $7.58. EV/Revenue TTM 14.7x is rich for a cash-burning battery maker, though NTM 6.5x reflects the growth. The $22 analyst mean target assumes the 2030 plan is fully funded and executed.

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Cascadia scorecard

Composite score 62: Fair. Confidence Medium, as of 17-Oct-2026.

PILLAR	RATIONALE	SCORE
Operating Quality	Pre-profit with no moat from earnings, but the technology is genuinely validated: 500 Wh/kg SiCore cells, NDAA-compliant supply, DoW funding, and paying customers. Gross margin hit 27% and the capital-light contract manufacturing model keeps balance sheet risk contained. Debt is negligible at $6.4M.	50
Recent Trend	Revenue +153% (Q1) then +126% (Q2), guidance raised twice in a row, net margin improved from -42% to -9% in a year, and EBITDA breakeven is imminent. One of the cleanest inflection trajectories in coverage.	85
Forward Growth	$24M European drone order, $100M+ multi-year Stark Future deal, Redwire Stalker Block 30 supply wins, and a $75M DoW OTA (mostly unfunded, tied to appropriations). The $140M FY26 guide is confirmed by orders, but 2027+ capacity depends on contract-manufacturing execution.	78
Valuation	DCF base $5.20 implies 31% downside at $7.58. EV/Revenue TTM 14.7x is rich for a cash-burning battery maker, though NTM 6.5x reflects the growth. The $22 analyst mean target assumes the 2030 plan is fully funded and executed.	44
Catalysts & Risk	Q3 earnings test H2 delivery, SiCore 500 commercial availability in Q4, and DoW milestone payments are near-term positives. Against that: the bulk of the $75M grant is unfunded, short interest sits near 17-19%, insider selling of $1.27M last quarter, and a 2.35 beta with the stock 68% off its highs. Two-sided skew.	55

Investment view

A Q3 2026 beat with clean cash conversion would lift Forward Growth and Trend and could justify the current multiple. A miss on H2 delivery or DoW milestone delays would confirm the valuation call and likely drive the stock toward the $5.20 base.

Investment view: Hold, Valuation Concerns. The $5.73 blended target implies -24%, balancing the $2.18 / $5.20 / $10.36 Bear / Base / Bull outcomes.

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